

A REAL-TIME DEEP LEARNING BASED DISASTER MONITORING SYSTEM USING YOLO WITH INTEGRATED DRONE AND SATELLITE IMAGERY

PROJECT REPORT

Submitted

by

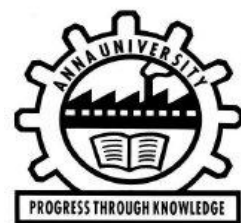
PREETHI .S (421122104070)

in partial fulfilment for the award of the degree of

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING

in

ELECTRONICS AND COMMUNICATION ENGINEERING



IFET COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING

(An Autonomous Institution)

Approved by AICTE, New Delhi and Accredited by NAAC & NBA

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MAY 2026

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to express my sincere gratitude to our Chairman **Mr. K.V. Raja**, Secretary **Mr.K.Shivaram Alva** and Treasurer **Mr.R.Vimal** for providing us with an excellent infrastructure and necessary resources to carry out this project.

I express my sincere thanks to Principal, **Dr.G.Mahendran**, IFET College of Engineering, for his constant encouragement throughout our course of study and providing all incitement facilities.

I am extremely grateful to treasured Dean Operations & Development **Dr.P.Kanimozhi**, and Head Academics **Dr.S.Jayalakshmi** for her incitement and created enthusiasm to make my project work wonderful and successful one.

I wish to record my valuable thanks to our trend setting Head of the Department **Dr.M.Margarat**, and Project Coordinator **Dr.K.Sagadevan**, for their permission and encouragement accorded to carry out this project.

I express my heartfelt gratitude to my guide **Mrs.M.Jayasudha**, for her valuable guidance and encouragement right from the commencement of this project work.

I also thank my Batch Coordinator **Dr.K.Sagadevan**, for his incitement and creative enthusiasm to make our project.

I am also very grateful to all teaching and non-teaching staff members of department of electronics and communication engineering in course of my project work.

I take this privilege to express our sense of gratitude to our beloved parents and friends who have helped and guided us throughout the course.

ABSTRACT

It is important to monitor the occurrence of natural disasters in good time to reduce loss of lives and destruction of infrastructures. The paper initiates a disaster monitoring system in real-time which is governed by AI with both drone and satellite image as a way of automating disaster detection, visualization, and alert generation. The suggested model uses the two trained independently YOLOv8 deep learning networks that are optimized to both the drone and the satellite image streams. A real-time process of monitoring a folder is used to constantly scan added images and initiate automatic inquiry to decide on the nature and existence of a disaster. When the system detects the predicted disaster, it stores the classification of the disaster in focus, the confidence score, the source of the image and the reference of the image in a structured JSON file, which is then later used in visualization and to create alerts. Streamlit dynamic displays the results of the detection on a dashboard that views the disaster type, the level of confidence, graphical confidence signs, and a dynamic interactive geographic map with the latitude-longitude defined coordinates on it. This is done by automated SMS notification of a disaster. It has been experimentally confirmed that the drone-based model has a precision of 0.52, a recall of 0.36, an mAP at 0.5 of 0.35 and mAP at 0.5: 0.95 of 0.17 and the satellite-based model has a precision of 0.47, a recall of 0.34, mAP of 0.5 of 0.33 and mAP of 0.5: 0.95 of 0.17. The proposed framework shows an average relative increase in detection accuracy of 15- 25% compared to conventional single-source systems reporting mAP at 0.5 of 0.25-0.30. The low and constant inference latency also supports the merit of real-time viability and feasibility of the proposed system.

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

1	AI	Artificial Intelligence
2	UAV	Unmanned Aerial Vehicle
3	YOLO	You Only Look Once
4	CNN	Convolutional Neural Network
5	PR	Precision–Recall
6	mAP	Mean Average Precision
7	NDWI	Normalized Difference Water Index
8	NDVI	Normalized Difference Vegetation Index
9	SVM	Support Vector Machine
10	SMS	Short Message Service

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 BACKGROUND AND MOTIVATION

Natural disasters such as floods, earthquakes, hurricanes, wildfires, cyclones, landslides, and volcanic eruptions have significantly increased in frequency and intensity over the past few decades. These disasters result in extensive loss of human life, destruction of infrastructure, environmental degradation, and economic instability. Rapid urbanization, climate change, and environmental imbalance have further amplified the impact of such catastrophic events. As a result, there is a growing need for advanced technological systems capable of detecting and monitoring disasters in real time. Traditional disaster monitoring systems relied heavily on manual field surveys, human interpretation of satellite imagery, and delayed reporting mechanisms. While these methods were useful in earlier decades, they are no longer sufficient to handle the speed and complexity of modern disasters. Manual analysis is time-consuming, labor-intensive, and prone to human error. Additionally, during large-scale disasters, affected areas may become inaccessible, making ground-based monitoring extremely difficult. The development of remote sensing technologies, including satellite imaging and unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs) or drones, has revolutionized disaster observation. Satellite imagery provides wide-area coverage and enables monitoring of large geographic regions. On the other hand, drones provide high-resolution localized imagery, allowing detailed inspection of damaged infrastructure and affected zones. However, the major challenge lies in analyzing the massive volume of images generated by these platforms. Artificial Intelligence (AI), particularly Deep Learning, has emerged as a powerful solution to this challenge. Deep learning-based computer vision models can automatically analyze images and detect disaster-related patterns with high accuracy and speed. Among various object detection models, YOLO

(You Only Look Once) has gained significant attention due to its real-time detection capability and computational efficiency. The motivation behind this project is to design and implement a real-time AI-based disaster monitoring system that integrates both satellite and drone imagery using YOLOv8 architecture. The system aims to automate disaster detection, visualization, logging, and alert generation in order to enhance emergency response effectiveness and situational awareness.

1.2 ROLE OF AI IN DISASTER MONITORING

Artificial Intelligence has transformed multiple domains including healthcare, transportation, agriculture, and security. In recent years, AI has also become a crucial component in disaster management systems. The ability of deep learning models to learn complex visual patterns makes them highly suitable for detecting disaster-related features such as flooded areas, collapsed buildings, wildfire smoke, and storm damage. Computer vision models based on Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) have shown remarkable success in image classification, segmentation, and object detection tasks. Object detection models such as Faster R-CNN, SSD, and YOLO have been widely used in remote sensing applications. Among these, YOLO stands out due to its single-stage detection pipeline, which allows high-speed inference without sacrificing much accuracy. YOLOv8, the latest version in the YOLO family, offers improved feature extraction, better bounding-box regression, and enhanced confidence estimation. Its architecture includes a backbone for feature extraction, a neck for multi-scale feature fusion, and a detection head for predicting bounding boxes and class probabilities. This makes it highly suitable for real-time disaster detection scenarios.

In disaster monitoring, AI systems can:

- Automatically detect disaster-affected regions.
- Classify the type of disaster.

- Provide confidence scores for prediction reliability.
- Reduce human intervention.
- Enable faster decision-making.
- Operate continuously without fatigue.

Despite the progress in AI-based detection systems, most existing frameworks focus on either satellite imagery or drone imagery independently. Single-source systems often lack robustness and fail to capture both large-scale and fine-grained disaster information simultaneously. Therefore, integrating multiple data sources within a unified AI framework becomes essential. This project leverages the strength of dual YOLOv8 models trained separately on satellite and drone datasets to ensure domain-specific learning while maintaining consistent disaster classification outputs.

1.3 OBJECTIVE OF THE PROJECT

The primary objective of this project is to design and implement a real-time AI-based disaster monitoring system using YOLOv8 with integrated drone and satellite imagery. The specific objectives of the project are as follows:

- To develop a real-time disaster detection system capable of automatically identifying disaster events from incoming satellite and drone images without manual intervention.
- To implement dual YOLOv8-based deep learning models trained separately on satellite and drone datasets to ensure domain-specific feature learning and improved detection accuracy.
- To classify multiple types of disasters such as floods, hurricanes, tornadoes, earthquakes, volcanic eruptions, and wildfires using supervised object detection techniques.
- To design a folder-based continuous mechanism using a watchdog system

that automatically detects and processes newly added images in real time.

- To generate structured detection outputs including disaster type, confidence score, image source, and image reference in JSON and CSV formats for further analysis and logging.
- To implement a confidence-aware prediction mechanism that provides transparency in detection results and supports informed decision-making.
- To develop a dynamic visualization dashboard using Streamlit that displays real-time disaster information, confidence charts, and interactive geographic maps.
- To integrate geospatial visualization features by mapping disaster locations using predefined latitude and longitude coordinates for improved situational awareness.
- To incorporate an automated SMS alert system that notifies users immediately upon disaster detection to enable faster emergency response.
- To ensure low inference latency and operational efficiency so that the system remains suitable for real-time deployment in time-critical disaster management scenarios.

1.4 OVERVIEW OF THE PROJECT

The proposed system is a real-time deep learning-based disaster monitoring framework that integrates drone and satellite imagery for automated disaster detection and visualization. The system architecture is modular and consists of five primary components:

- Image Acquisition Module
- Disaster Detection Module
- Confidence Estimation Module

- Alert and Logging Module
- Visualization Dashboard Module

The system operates using a folder-based real-time monitoring mechanism. Incoming images from satellite and drone sources are stored in structured directories. A watchdog-based monitoring script continuously observes these folders. Whenever a new image is added, the system automatically triggers the detection pipeline.

Two independently trained YOLOv8 models are used:

- A satellite-based disaster detection model
- A drone-based disaster detection model

This separation ensures that each model learns features specific to its domain, avoiding scale mismatch and improving detection reliability.

After processing, the system generates structured outputs including:

- Disaster type
- Confidence score
- Image source
- Image reference

The results are stored in JSON and CSV formats. A Streamlit-based dashboard dynamically reads these outputs and displays:

- Predicted disaster label
- Confidence percentage
- Graphical confidence chart
- Interactive geographic map with latitude and longitude

Additionally, an automated SMS alert system users whenever a disaster is

detected, ensuring real-time communication. The integration of continuous monitoring, AI-based detection, geospatial visualization, and automated alerts makes the proposed framework a complete operational disaster monitoring solution rather than just a detection model.

1.5 PROBLEM STATEMENT

Despite significant advancements in remote sensing and artificial intelligence technologies, real-time disaster monitoring remains a major global challenge. Existing disaster monitoring systems suffer from several limitations that reduce their effectiveness in practical emergency response scenarios. One of the primary problems is delayed situational awareness. Traditional systems rely heavily on manual image interpretation and offline processing of satellite imagery. This results in delayed detection, which can critically affect rescue operations and emergency response timing. Secondly, most existing AI-based disaster detection systems are single-source dependent. Systems that rely only on satellite imagery may fail to capture fine-grained structural damages due to lower spatial resolution. Conversely, drone-only systems lack large-area coverage and cannot monitor regional-scale disasters effectively. The absence of an integrated multi-source approach limits overall detection reliability. Another major issue is the lack of real-time automation. Many research prototypes perform batch inference, where images are manually uploaded and processed offline. Such systems are unsuitable for continuous monitoring and time-critical disaster response applications. Furthermore, several systems focus solely on detection accuracy while neglecting operational aspects such as:

- Structured logging of detection results
- Confidence-aware decision support
- Real-time visualization
- Geographic mapping of disaster locations

- Automated alert mechanisms

Without these components, disaster models remain theoretical research outputs rather than deployable real-world solutions. There is also the challenge of confidence interpretation. In emergency management, it is not enough to detect a disaster; decision-makers must understand how reliable the detection is. Systems that fail to provide transparent confidence scores may lead to either false alarms or missed detections. Additionally, handling continuous image streams efficiently while maintaining low inference latency is a computational challenge. High-resolution satellite and drone images require optimized processing to ensure real-time responsiveness. Therefore, the core problem addressed in this project can be defined as:

“Designing and implementing a fully automated, real-time AI-based disaster monitoring system that integrates both satellite and drone imagery, provides accurate multi-class disaster detection using YOLOv8, generates structured outputs, visualizes geospatial disaster information dynamically, and triggers automated alerts with minimal latency.”

The system must:

- Operate continuously without manual intervention.
- Accurately classify multiple disaster types.
- Handle domain-specific differences between satellite and drone images.
- Provide confidence-aware predictions.
- Ensure low inference time suitable for real-time deployment.
- Offer user-friendly visualization and alert mechanisms.

Addressing these challenges will bridge the gap between academic disaster detection research and practical, deployable disaster monitoring systems.

CHAPTER-2

LITERATURE SURVEY

TITLE: Optimizing Deep Learning Models for Climate-Related Natural Disaster Detection from UAV Images and Remote Sensing Data.

AUTHOR'S: Kim VanExel, Samendra Sherchan, Siyan Liu.

YEAR: 2025

ABSTRACT: This research study utilized artificial intelligence (AI) to detect natural disasters from aerial images. Flooding and desertification were two natural disasters taken into consideration. The Climate Change Dataset was created by compiling various open-access data sources. This dataset contains 6334 aerial images from UAV (unmanned aerial vehicles) images and satellite images. The Climate Change Dataset was then used to train Deep Learning (DL) models to identify natural disasters. Four different Machine Learning (ML) models were used: convolutional neural network (CNN), DenseNet201, VGG16, and ResNet50. These ML models were trained on our Climate Change Dataset so that their performance could be compared. DenseNet201 was chosen for optimization. All four ML models performed well. DenseNet201 and ResNet50 achieved the highest testing accuracies of 99.37% and 99.21%, respectively. This research project demonstrates the potential of AI to address environmental challenges, such as climate change-related natural disasters. This study's approach is novel by creating a new dataset, optimizing an ML model, cross validating, and presenting desertification as one of our natural disasters for DL detection. Three categories were used (Flooded, Desert, Neither). Our study relates to AI for Climate Change and Environmental Sustainability. Drone emergency response would be a practical application for our research project.

TITLE: Harnessing Geospatial Artificial Intelligence and Deep Learning for Landslide Inventory Mapping: Advances, Challenges, and Emerging Directions.

AUTHOR'S: Xiao Chen, Wenwen Li, Chia-Yu Hsu, Samantha T. Arundel and Bretwood Higman.

YEAR: 2025

ABSTRACT: Recent advancements in artificial intelligence (AI) and deep learning enable more accurate, scalable, and automated mapping. This paper provides a comprehensive review of the applications of AI, particularly deep learning, in landslide inventory mapping. In addition to examining commonly used data sources and model architectures, we explore innovative strategies such as feature enhancement and fusion, attention-boosted techniques, and advanced learning approaches, including active learning and transfer learning, to enhance model adaptability and predictability. We also highlight the remaining challenges and potential research directions, including the estimation of more diverse variables in landslide mapping, multimodal data alignment, modelling regional variability and replicability, as well as issues related to data misinterpretation and model explainability. This review aims to serve as a useful resource for researchers and practitioners, promoting the integration of deep learning into landslide research and disaster management.

TITLE: Landslide Assessment Classification Using Deep Neural Networks Based on Climate and Geospatial Data.

AUTHORS: Yadviga Tynchenko, Vladislav Kukartsev, Vadim Tynchenko, Oksana Kukartseva, Tatyana Panfilova, Alexey Gladkov, Van Nguyen, Ivan Malashin.

YEAR: 2024

ABSTRACT: This study presents a method for classifying landslide triggers

and sizes using climate and geospatial data. The landslide data were sourced from the Global Landslide Catalog (GLC), which identifies rainfall-triggered landslide events globally, regardless of size, impact, or location. Compiled from 2007 to 2018 at NASA Goddard Space Flight Center, the GLC includes various mass movements triggered by rainfall and other events. Climatic data for the 10 years preceding each landslide event, including variables such as rainfall amounts, humidity, pressure, and temperature, were integrated with the landslide data. This dataset was then used to classify landslide triggers and sizes using deep neural networks (DNNs) optimized through genetic algorithm (GA)-driven hyperparameter tuning. The optimized DNN models achieved accuracies of 0.67 and 0.82, respectively, in multiclass classification tasks. This research demonstrates the effectiveness of GA to enhance landslide disaster risk management.

TITLE: Deep Learning for Exploring Landslides with Remote Sensing and Geo-Environmental Data: Frameworks, Progress, Challenges, and Opportunities.

AUTHOR'S: Qi Zhang, Teng Wang

YEAR: 2024

ABSTRACT: This article offers a comprehensive AI-centric review of deep learning in exploring landslides with remote-sensing techniques, breaking new ground beyond traditional methodologies. We categorize deep learning tasks into five key frameworks—classification, detection, segmentation, sequence, and the hybrid framework—and analyse their specific applications in landslide-related tasks. Following the presented frameworks, we review state-of-the-art studies and provide clear insights into the powerful capability of deep learning models for landslide detection, mapping, susceptibility mapping, and displacement prediction. We then discuss current challenges and future research

directions, emphasizing areas like model generalizability and advanced network architectures. Aimed at serving both newcomers and experts on remote sensing and engineering geology, this review highlights the potential of deep learning in advancing landslide risk management and preservation.

TITLE: A disaster classification application using convolutional neural network by performing data augmentation

AUTHOR'S: Mummaneni Sobhana, Smitha Chowdary Chaparala, Devaganugula N. V. S. L. S. Indira, Konduru Kranthi Kumar

YEAR: 2022

ABSTRACT: Natural disasters are catastrophic events and cause havoc to human life. These events occur in the most unpredictable times and are beyond human control. The aftermath of the disasters is devastating ranging from loss of life to relocation of large groups of the population. With the development in the domains of computer vision (CV) and Image processing, machine learning and deep learning models can integrate images and perform predictions. Deep learning techniques employ many robust techniques and provide significant results even in the case of images. The detection of natural disasters without human intervention requires the help of deep learning techniques. The project aims to employ a multi-layered convolutional neural network (CNN) organization to classify the images related to natural disasters related to earthquakes, floods, cyclones, and wildfires.

CHAPTER 3

EXISTING SYSTEM

Existing disaster monitoring and classification systems primarily rely on remote sensing technologies, aerial surveillance, and artificial intelligence techniques to identify and assess natural disasters. Over the years, researchers and disaster management agencies have developed systems that utilize satellite imagery, drone-based imaging, and machine learning algorithms to monitor events such as floods, wildfires, earthquakes, landslides, and cyclones. While these systems have significantly improved disaster response strategies compared to traditional manual surveys, they still face technical and operational limitations. This section explains the major components of existing systems, focusing on satellite-based approaches, drone-based monitoring methods, and current classification techniques used in prior research.

3.1 SATELLITE BASED DISASTER MONITORING SYSTEM

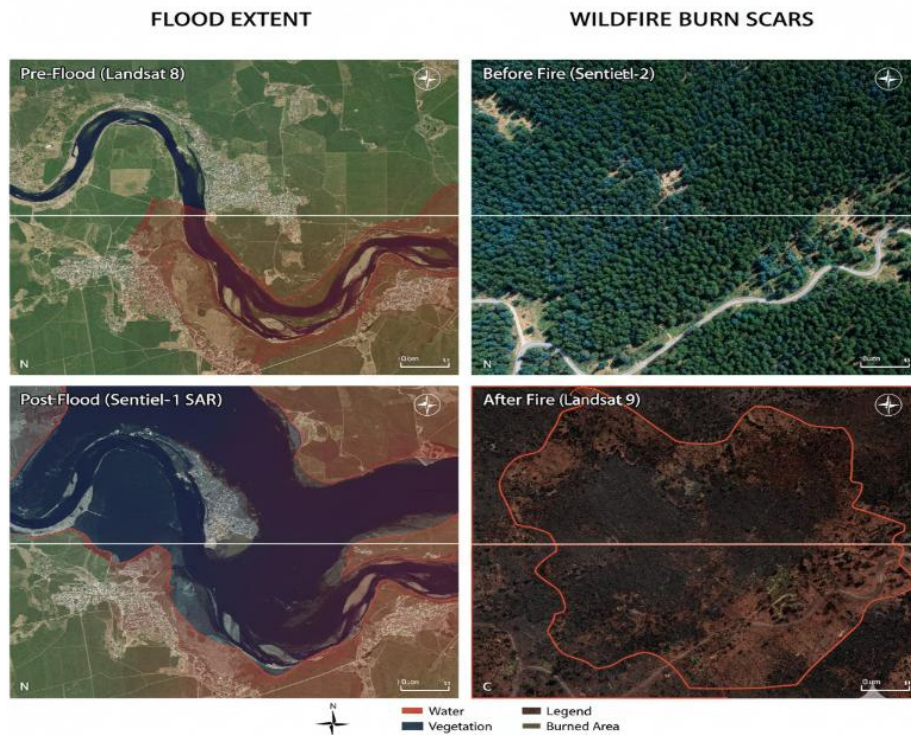


FIG 1: Representative Satellite Imagery for Flood and Wildfire Detection from Literature

Satellite imagery is one of the most widely used sources for disaster monitoring due to its ability to capture large geographic areas within a single frame. Government space agencies and research organizations continuously provide multi-spectral, hyperspectral, and thermal satellite data for environmental monitoring and disaster management. Satellite-based disaster detection systems follow a structured workflow that begins with image acquisition using earth observation satellites equipped with optical and infrared sensors. These sensors capture detailed information about water bodies, vegetation cover, surface temperature, and structural changes on the Earth's surface. Since raw satellite images may contain noise, atmospheric distortions, and resolution inconsistencies, preprocessing techniques such as radiometric correction, geometric correction, image normalization, and cloud removal are applied to enhance data quality. After preprocessing, disaster-related features are extracted using spectral indices and band analysis techniques. For example, the Normalized Difference Water Index (NDWI) is used to identify flooded regions, the Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI) helps detect vegetation stress or drought conditions, and thermal band analysis is used to recognize wildfire hotspots. Classification is then performed using machine learning algorithms such as Support Vector Machines (SVM), Decision Trees, and Random Forest classifiers. More recently, Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) have been adopted to automatically learn complex patterns and improve classification accuracy. The final outputs are converted into thematic disaster maps and visual representations to support emergency response planning and resource allocation. In practical applications, satellite imagery is widely used for flood and wildfire detection. For flood assessment, images captured before and after heavy rainfall events are compared to identify sudden expansions in water bodies and determine the extent of inundation. Wildfire detection relies on thermal infrared bands to detect temperature anomalies and active fire zones. Due to their wide-area coverage and continuous monitoring capability, satellite systems are highly effective for large-scale flood monitoring, forest fire, etc..

3.2 DRONE BASED DISASTER ASSESSMENT SYSTEMS

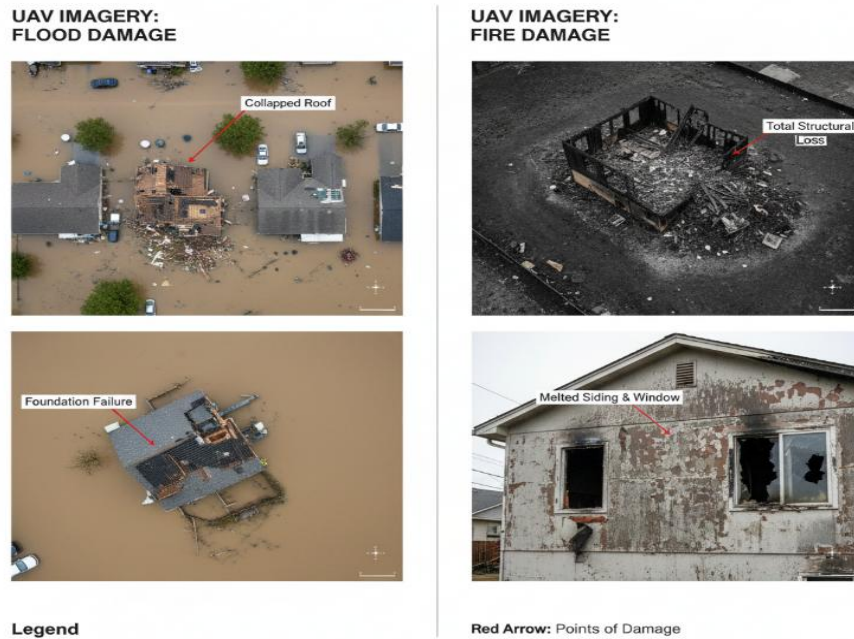


FIG 2: Drone-Based Disaster Imagery Used in Related Work for Earthquake and Flood Assessment

Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs), commonly known as drones, have gained significant importance in disaster assessment due to their ability to capture high-resolution images from low altitudes. Unlike satellites, drones can be rapidly deployed to specific disaster locations and provide detailed, localized information with greater spatial clarity. Drone-based disaster monitoring systems operate through a systematic workflow. After a disaster event, UAVs are deployed to the affected region to capture high-resolution aerial images and videos. The collected data is transmitted to ground control stations or cloud-based servers for processing. Image preprocessing and classification are then performed using deep learning models, particularly Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs), to identify disaster types and assess damage severity. The processed outputs are organized into structured reports that assist emergency response teams in planning rescue operations, allocating resources, and coordinating recovery efforts. Drone systems have diverse applications across

various disaster scenarios. In earthquake-affected areas, they inspect collapsed buildings, damaged bridges, cracked roads, and blocked transportation routes without risking human safety. During floods, drones monitor rising water levels, identify submerged structures, detect embankment breaches, and help locate stranded individuals. In wildfire situations, UAVs track fire spread, detect active hotspots, and assess burn severity. They are also used in landslide-prone regions to analyse slope instability and terrain deformation. Additionally, drones support search-and-rescue missions by scanning large areas quickly and providing live video feeds to control centres. Beyond immediate response, they contribute to damage documentation, insurance assessment, infrastructure recovery planning, and long-term environmental impact analysis.

3.3 LIMITATIONS OF EXISTING SYSTEMS

Although satellite and drone technologies have improved disaster monitoring, existing classification systems still exhibit several shortcomings. Traditional machine learning approaches require manual feature extraction, which limits adaptability to different disaster types. These models often struggle with complex environmental variations such as lighting differences, smoke, water reflections, and structural debris.

Even deep learning-based systems, though more powerful, face challenges such as:

- Dependence on large and well-labelled datasets
- Difficulty in handling multi-class disaster classification
- High computational requirements
- Limited real-time implementation capability
- Poor generalization across different geographic region

CHAPTER 4

PROPOSED SYSTEM

4.1 SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

The proposed AI-based disaster monitoring framework is designed with a structured and modular system architecture that enables real-time disaster detection and visualization. The framework continuously monitors disaster-related events using both drone imagery and satellite image sources. The architecture emphasizes automation, clarity, and modularity, all of which are essential for ensuring smooth data flow from image acquisition to alert generation and visualization. Figure 3 illustrates the complete block diagram of the proposed system, showing the interaction between major modules and the overall data flow throughout the framework.

The entire architecture shown in Figure 3 consists of five major interconnected modules:

- Image Acquisition and Continuous Monitoring Module.
- Disaster Detection Model (Drone and Satellite Processing Models).
- Confidence-Based Disaster Prediction Module.
- Alert and Logging Module.
- Real-Time Visualization Dashboard.

Functionally, as represented in Fig. 3, the system can also be grouped into four core modules: Image Acquisition Module, Disaster Detection Module, Alert Logging Module, and Visualization Dashboard Module. Each module performs a specific role and communicates with the others using structured data formats. The modular design enhances maintainability, simplifies debugging, and ensures smooth real-time execution of the system.

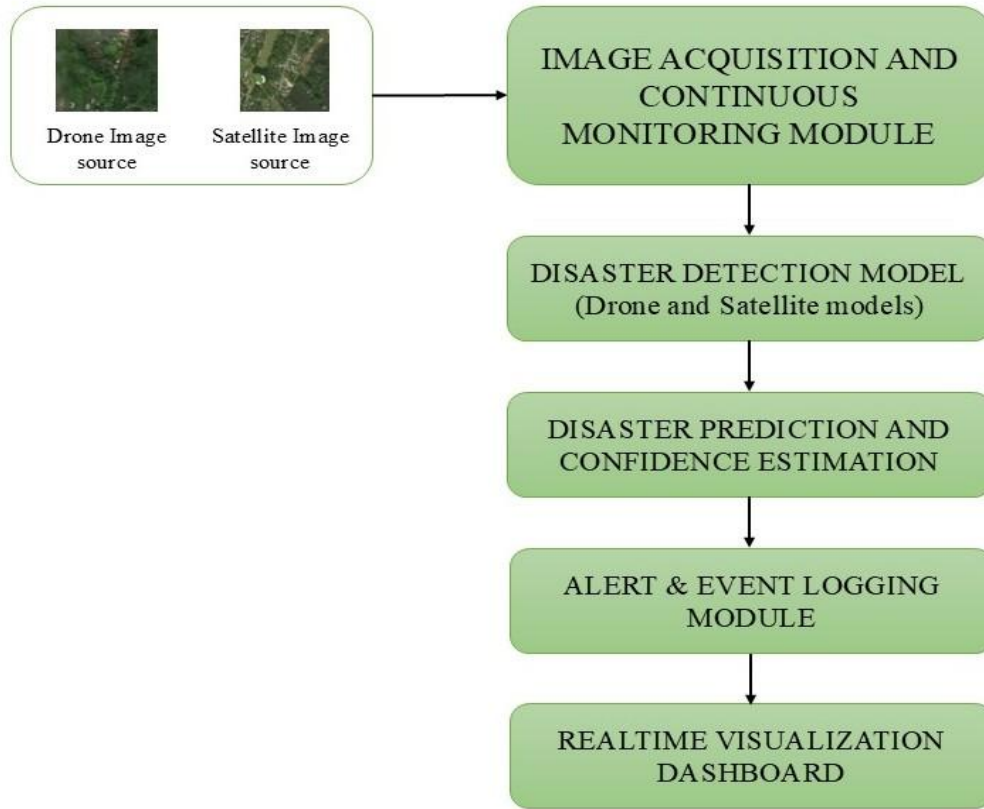


FIG 3: System Architecture of the Proposed AI-Based Disaster Monitoring Framework

4.1.1 IMAGE ACQUISITION MODULE

The Image Acquisition Module serves as the initial and most critical component of the system architecture, as it acts as the entry point for all incoming data. This module is responsible for receiving disaster-related images from various sources and preparing them for further processing. In the proposed framework, image acquisition is implemented using a folder-based real-time monitoring mechanism rather than direct sensor streaming. This approach ensures simplicity, flexibility, and ease of demonstration while maintaining real-time behaviour. The system contains a dedicated main directory named Incoming Images, which functions as the central repository for all input data. Within this directory, separate subfolders are maintained to store drone images and satellite images. This organized folder hierarchy allows the system to automatically distinguish between different image sources without requiring manual input. The images stored in these folders are assumed to be captured

during drone missions or retrieved from satellite imaging systems during disaster-related scenarios. A file monitoring mechanism continuously runs in the background and scans the Incoming Images directory to detect newly added image files. Whenever a valid image file in formats such as JPG or PNG is identified, the monitoring system automatically triggers the next stage of processing. This event-driven design eliminates the need for manual refresh operations and enables uninterrupted system operation. As illustrated in Fig. 3, the Image Acquisition Module forwards the detected images to the Disaster Detection Module through an automated workflow. Each image is processed only once, ensuring no duplication or data loss. The structured folder-based approach effectively simulates real-time image streaming, making it suitable for experimental validation as well as live system demonstrations. Another important function of this module is source identification. Based on the file path, the system determines whether the image originates from a drone or satellite source. This information is later incorporated into the output for labeling and contextual understanding. By separating image acquisition logic from detection logic, the architecture maintains clean modular boundaries and improves system scalability and maintainability.

4.1.2 DISASTER DETECTION MODULE

The Disaster Detection Module represents the core intelligence of the proposed framework. It is responsible for analysing incoming images, determining whether a disaster is present, identifying the disaster category, assigning a confidence score, and generating structured output data. As shown in Fig. 3, this module acts as a bridge between raw image input and meaningful disaster-related information. Once an image is detected by the Image Acquisition Module, it is forwarded to the Disaster Detection Module for analysis. The system initially performs basic preprocessing operations such as extracting the image filename and determining the source (drone or satellite). Source identification plays an important role in labelling outputs and

maintaining clarity within the visualization dashboard. The detection logic is designed to differentiate between pre-disaster and disaster scenarios. This distinction is achieved through analysis of the image naming convention. If the filename contains the term “pre_disaster,” the system categorizes it as a non-disaster image and marks it accordingly. This strategy helps prevent false alerts and ensures that only relevant disaster events proceed to further processing. For images classified as disaster-related, the system extracts the disaster type directly from the filename. This ensures alignment between dataset labeling and detection results. Disaster categories such as floods, tornadoes, hurricanes, wildfires, and earthquakes are identified using predefined naming patterns. The extracted disaster label becomes a key component of the final output. The module also assigns a confidence score to each detected disaster. This score reflects the certainty level associated with the prediction result and is included in the structured output. The confidence value enhances transparency and helps users interpret detection reliability. Later, this score is visually represented in the dashboard using graphical elements. After completing analysis, the Disaster Detection Module generates a structured output file named results. Json. This JSON file contains essential information including detection status, disaster label, confidence score, image source, and image filename. As depicted in Fig. 3, this file serves as the primary communication channel between the detection module and the visualization dashboard. By using a standardized JSON format, the system ensures seamless data exchange and compatibility with visualization tools. The module continuously updates this file whenever a new image is processed, enabling uninterrupted real-time data flow across the framework.

4.1.3 ALERT AND LOGGING MODULE

The Alert and Logging Module enhances the practical applicability of the system by recording detected disaster events and generating notifications when necessary. As shown in Fig. 3, this module operates in coordination with both the Disaster Detection Module and the Visualization Dashboard Module, and it

becomes active only when a disaster event is confirmed. When the Disaster Detection Module identifies a disaster, the alert mechanism is triggered. The system sends an SMS notification containing key information such as disaster type, confidence score, and image source. This real-time alert ensures that critical information reaches relevant authorities or users without delay. To prevent repeated alerts for the same event, the system maintains an internal alert state mechanism. Once an alert is issued for a specific disaster event, duplicate notifications are suppressed until a new disaster event is detected. This design prevents unnecessary message repetition and ensures reliability of the alert system. In addition to real-time notifications, the module maintains a structured log file in text format. Each log entry includes organized details such as disaster type, confidence level, source information, and image reference. This cumulative log serves as a historical record of all detected events and can be used for auditing, reporting, or future analysis. As illustrated in Fig. 3, the Alert and Logging Module interacts with both the Disaster Detection Module and the Visualization Dashboard. This integration ensures that alert generation, logging, and visualization occur synchronously, maintaining consistency across the entire framework. By incorporating alerting and logging features, the system transitions from a passive monitoring tool to an active disaster awareness solution.

4.1.4 VISUALIZATION DASHBOARD MODULE

The Visualization Dashboard Module is the final and user-interactive component of the system architecture. It presents disaster information in a clear, user-friendly, and real-time visual format. As shown in Fig. 3, the dashboard continuously reads data from the results. Json file and dynamically updates the display. The dashboard is implemented using the Streamlit framework, which supports real-time updates and interactive visualization components. Once launched, the dashboard periodically checks the results. Json file for new updates. Whenever new detection data is available, the dashboard refreshes

automatically without requiring manual intervention. The detected disaster type is displayed prominently for easy visibility. Along with the disaster label, the confidence score is shown as a numerical percentage. To enhance interpretability, the confidence value is also represented graphically using a bar chart. This visual representation allows users to quickly assess the reliability of the detection. A significant feature of the dashboard is geographical visualization. The system uses a predefined location dataset containing latitude and longitude coordinates corresponding to disaster-prone areas. Based on the image name, the appropriate coordinates are retrieved and displayed on an interactive map. As illustrated in Fig. 3, this map-based visualization provides spatial context and improves situational awareness. The dashboard also displays the source of the image, clearly indicating whether the detected disaster was identified through drone imagery or satellite imagery. This information helps users understand the coverage and reliability of the data source. If no disaster is detected, the dashboard displays a clear status message indicating a safe or pre-disaster condition. This ensures that the interface remains informative even during normal conditions. The Visualization Dashboard Module operates in synchronization with the Alert and Logging Module, ensuring that alerts are generated only when the dashboard confirms a disaster event. This coordinated operation guarantees consistency and stability across the entire system.

4.2 DATASET DESCRIPTION

The performance and reliability of an AI-based disaster monitoring system largely depend on the quality, diversity, and structure of the dataset used for training and evaluation. In the proposed system, disaster detection is performed using two separate datasets: satellite imagery and drone imagery. Both datasets are derived from the xView2 disaster dataset, which is publicly available on Kaggle. The xView2 dataset is widely used in disaster analysis research and contains high-resolution images captured before and after real-world disaster events. It includes corresponding annotation files in text format,

which provide disaster-related labels required for supervised model training and validation. All images are provided in JPG format, ensuring compatibility with standard computer vision libraries. To maintain modularity and clarity, the satellite and drone datasets are stored separately, allowing independent model training while maintaining consistent disaster classification categories.

4.2.1 SATELLITE DISASTER DATASET

The satellite disaster dataset consists of high-resolution satellite images captured over disaster-affected regions across various geographical locations. These images provide a broad, large-scale view of disaster impact, making them suitable for regional monitoring. The dataset includes both pre-disaster and post-disaster images. Pre-disaster images represent normal environmental conditions, while post-disaster images illustrate damage caused by events such as floods, hurricanes, wildfires, earthquakes, tornadoes, and landslides. This distinction helps the AI model learn visual differences between normal and disaster-affected regions.

The satellite dataset includes the following disaster categories:

- Flood
- Fire
- Cyclone
- Earthquake
- Hurricane
- Volcanic Eruption
- Wildfire
- Storm Damage
- Landslide

Figure 4 shows representative satellite images demonstrating large-scale disaster impact. Flood events appear as extensive water coverage, wildfire damage is visible through burnt vegetation and smoke patterns, and hurricane

damage can be identified through structural destruction over wide areas. These images are particularly useful for understanding regional disaster patterns.

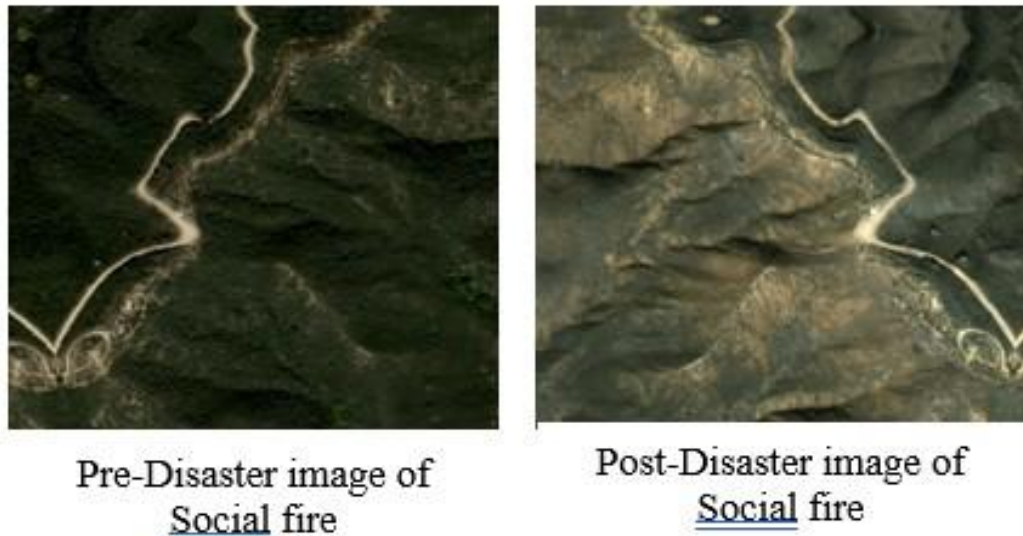


FIG 4: Sample Images of Satellite Dataset

The dataset is organized in a structured hierarchical directory format, as defined in the satellite YAML configuration file. Separate train and val folders are maintained to ensure proper model evaluation and to prevent data leakage between training and validation phases. Each satellite image is associated with a corresponding text label file that stores disaster class information consistent with the YAML configuration. This structured labelling enables supervised learning and ensures classification consistency. Although satellite imagery is highly effective for large-area disaster detection, it may lack fine-grained details necessary for localized damage assessment due to its top-down perspective. The proposed system addresses this limitation by integrating satellite data with high-resolution drone imagery.

Annotation Process:

Bounding box annotations are provided in YOLO format. Each image has a corresponding text file containing the disaster class index and normalized bounding box coordinates, enabling object-level disaster detection.

4.2.2 DRONE DISASTER DATASET

The drone disaster dataset consists of low-altitude aerial images captured using unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs). These images provide detailed and high-resolution views of disaster-affected regions, enabling close inspection of structural damage, debris accumulation, and localized flooding. Similar to the satellite dataset, drone images are derived from the xView2 collection and follow a consistent labelling framework to maintain semantic alignment between models. Drone imagery captures disaster impact at a much finer scale compared to satellite images. It is particularly useful for assessing building collapse, damaged roads, flooded residential areas, and infrastructure failure. Structural damage resulting from earthquakes, cyclone impacts, hurricanes, and urban collapse is more clearly visible in drone images. The dataset also includes variations in camera angles, flight altitudes, and motion blur, reflecting realistic drone deployment conditions.

The disaster categories in the drone dataset are aligned with the satellite dataset to ensure classification consistency:

- Flood
- Fire
- Earthquake Damage
- Cyclone Damage
- Hurricane Damage
- Urban Structural Collapse
- Forest Fire
- Landslide

Figure 5 presents sample drone images that highlight detailed disaster scenarios. Flood-affected streets, collapsed buildings after earthquakes, and debris accumulation are clearly observable. Such detailed visual information is essential for accurate damage assessment and situational analysis.



FIG 5: Sample Images Of Drone Dataset

Like the satellite dataset, the drone dataset is organized into train and val folders as defined in the drone YAML configuration file. Each image has an associated text label file specifying the disaster class, enabling supervised training. The consistency in disaster categories between satellite and drone datasets allows both models to operate within the same classification framework. The drone dataset complements the satellite dataset by providing localized, high-detail visual information. While satellite imagery offers a macro-level overview of disaster impact, drone imagery provides micro-level analysis necessary for precise damage evaluation.

Annotation Process:

Drone images were manually annotated using YOLO-compatible labelling tools. Bounding boxes were carefully placed around disaster-affected regions to ensure accuracy. Special attention was given to visually ambiguous areas to minimize annotation noise and improve detection reliability.

4.3 MODEL TRAINING AND CONFIGURATION

An effective real-time AI-based disaster monitoring system requires proper integration of a deep learning model along with carefully selected

training parameters. In this project, the YOLOv8 object detection model is used to identify disaster-related patterns in both satellite and drone images. YOLOv8 was selected due to its high detection accuracy and real-time inference capability. Separate models are trained for satellite and drone datasets to ensure domain-specific learning, while maintaining a consistent output interpretation framework. This section describes the YOLOv8 architecture, training configuration, learning behaviour during training, and dataset class mapping using YAML configuration files.

4.3.1 YOLO ARCHITECTURE

The proposed disaster monitoring system utilizes the YOLOv8 architecture as the core detection model. YOLO (You Only Look Once) is a single-stage object detection algorithm designed to perform detection in a single forward pass of the network. This design significantly reduces inference time compared to multi-stage detection frameworks, making YOLOv8 suitable for real-time disaster monitoring applications.

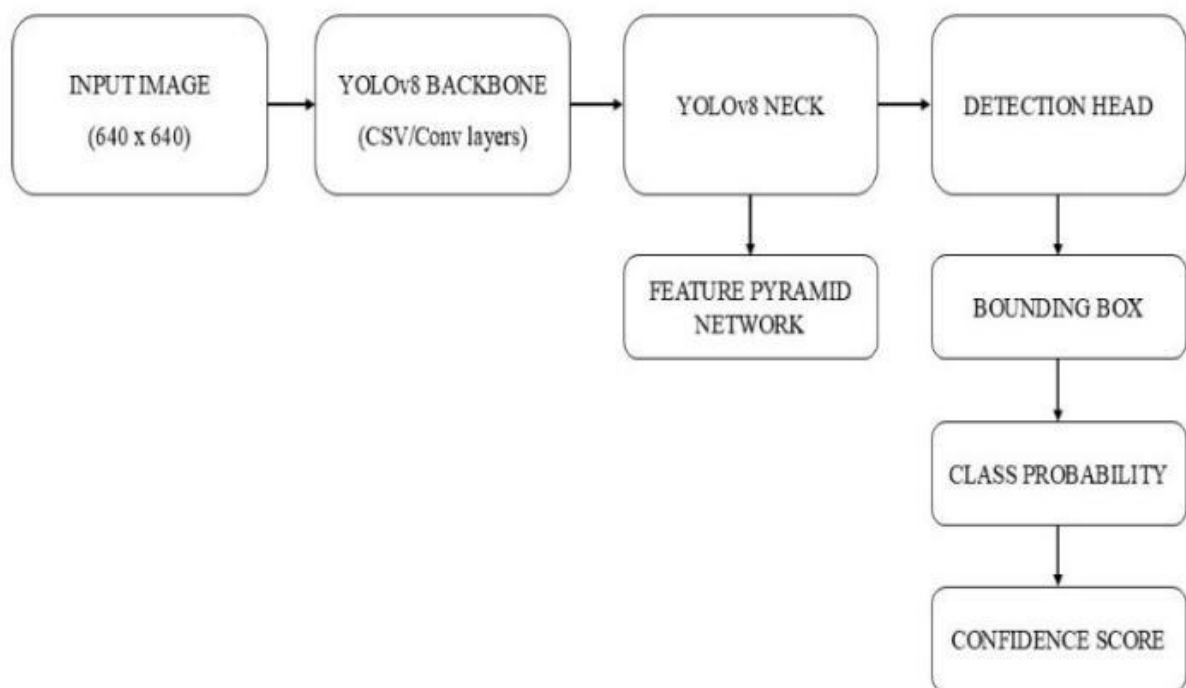


FIG 6: Architecture Of the YOLOv8 Model Used For Real-Time Disaster Detection

The YOLOv8 architecture consists of multiple major components, namely the input image layer, backbone network, neck network, and detection head, as shown in Fig. 6. Each component plays an important role in converting raw image data into meaningful disaster detection outputs. The incoming images are resized to a fixed resolution before being sent to the model. This resizing ensures uniformity across the dataset and allows efficient processing during both training and inference. Maintaining a fixed input size is essential for convolutional operations and consistent feature extraction. The backbone network of YOLOv8 extracts hierarchical features from the input image. It consists of multiple convolutional layers that first learn low-level features such as edges and textures, and then higher-level semantic features such as flooded regions, burnt vegetation, collapsed buildings, and damaged infrastructure. These learned representations help the model differentiate between disaster and non-disaster areas. The backbone uses optimized convolutional blocks that balance feature richness and computational efficiency. This is especially important for disaster monitoring systems where timely detection is critical. The backbone enables the model to handle various disaster scenarios captured from different viewpoints by effectively extracting both spatial and contextual features. The neck component of YOLOv8 improves feature fusion at multiple scales. As shown in Fig. 6, a Feature Pyramid Network (FPN) is used to combine feature maps from different backbone levels. Multi-scale detection is essential because disaster-affected areas vary in size depending on the image source and disaster type. For example, large flood regions may be visible in satellite imagery, while localized structural damage may appear in drone imagery. The FPN preserves spatial information at different resolutions, enabling detection of both large-scale and small-scale disaster patterns. The final component is the detection head. It predicts bounding box coordinates, class probabilities, and confidence scores for detected regions. Each prediction includes a confidence score indicating how certain the model is about the detected disaster-related region. This confidence score plays an important role in

the proposed system, as it is later displayed on the dashboard and used for alert generation. Although both satellite and drone models use the same YOLOv8 architecture, they are trained separately using their respective datasets to ensure domain-specific learning while maintaining a unified detection framework.

4.3.2 TRAINING PARAMETERS

The training process is a crucial stage in developing an effective disaster detection model. The YOLOv8 model was trained using the xView2 dataset obtained from Kaggle. The training configuration is defined using YAML files, which specify dataset paths, class names, and training and validation directories. The dataset is divided into training and validation folders. The training set is used to update model parameters, while the validation set is used to evaluate model performance during training. This separation ensures that the model can generalize to unseen data and helps prevent overfitting. The training procedure optimizes multiple loss components, including bounding box loss, classification loss, and distribution focal loss. Bounding box loss measures the accuracy of predicted box positions, classification loss evaluates the correctness of predicted disaster classes, and distribution focal loss improves bounding box regression quality. Together, these loss components guide the model toward accurate disaster detection. Both satellite and drone models were trained for approximately 60 epochs. This number of epochs was selected empirically to ensure sufficient exposure to training data without overfitting. During training, the YOLO loss function—which includes localization loss, confidence loss, and classification loss—gradually decreases. Localization loss penalizes bounding box prediction errors, confidence loss measures object presence prediction accuracy, and classification loss evaluates class prediction performance. These loss values are continuously monitored to assess learning progress. As shown in Fig. 7, the training and validation loss curves follow a consistent downward trend across epochs. The decreasing training loss indicates successful learning of disaster-related features, while the close alignment between training and validation

loss suggests stable learning behaviour.

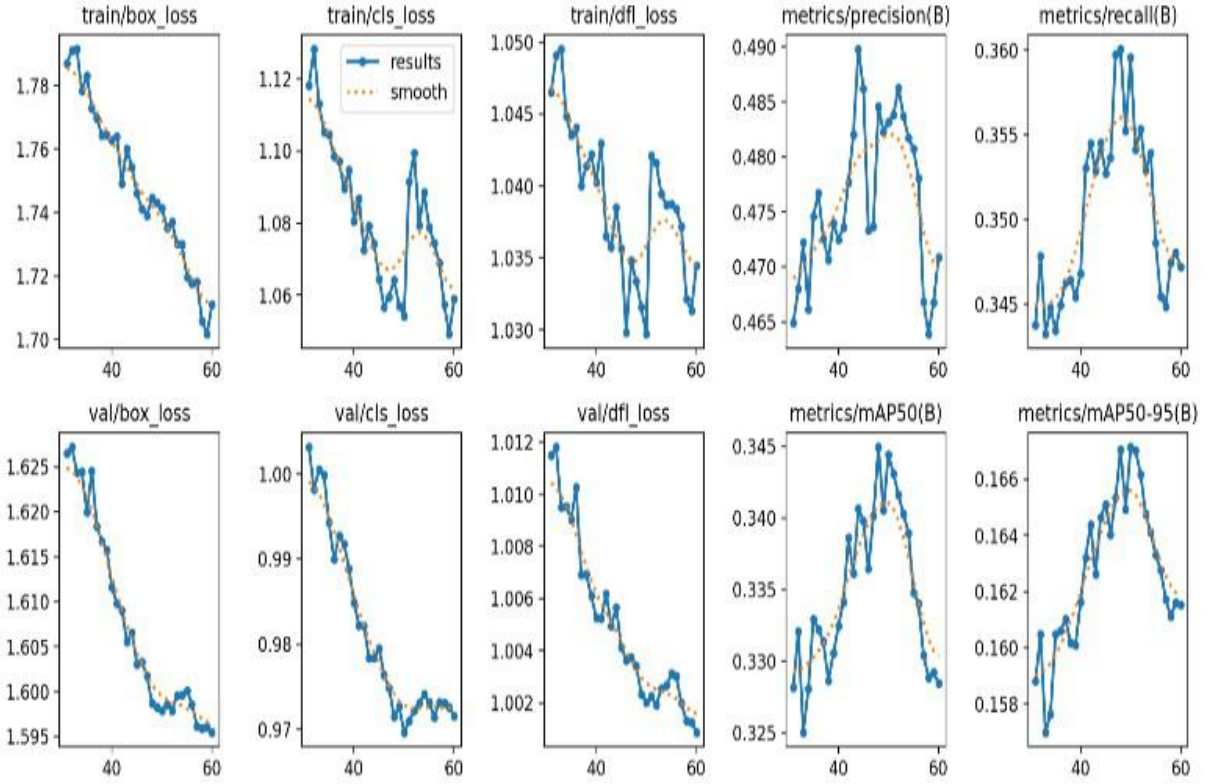


FIG 7: Training and validation loss curves for the satellite disaster detection model.

In addition to loss metrics, precision and recall are evaluated during training. Precision measures the proportion of correctly identified disaster instances among detected instances, while recall measures the model’s ability to detect all actual disaster occurrences. Maintaining a balance between precision and recall is critical in disaster monitoring systems, as both false alarms and missed detections can have serious consequences. Mean Average Precision (mAP) is used as an overall performance metric. The observed mAP values indicate that the model effectively learns to detect multiple disaster classes under varying image conditions. Satellite and drone datasets are trained separately using their respective YAML configurations to ensure domain-specific learning while maintaining consistent output structure. The trained models are saved and integrated into the real-time detection pipeline.

Table I: Training parameters used for the proposed YOLO-based disaster detection system

PARAMETER	VALUE
Model	YOLO-based CNN
Input image size	640 × 640
Batch size	16
Number of epochs	50
Learning rate	0.001
Optimizer	Adam
Loss function	Cross-entropy + IoU
Confidence threshold	0.25
IoU threshold	0.50
Dataset split	70% Train / 20% Validation / 10% Test
Number of classes	4
Disaster classes	Volcano, Hurricane, Tornado, Earthquake

4.3.3 CLASS MAPPING AND DATASET CONFIGURATION

Proper class mapping and dataset formatting are essential for effective supervised learning. The proposed system uses YAML configuration files to define dataset root directories, training and validation paths, and disaster class names. Separate YAML files are maintained for satellite and drone datasets. The disaster classes correspond to real-life disaster scenarios present in the xView2 dataset, including flood, wildfire, hurricane, earthquake, tornado, and related calamities. Each class is assigned a numerical index, which is consistently used across image labels and model predictions. Each image in the dataset has a corresponding text label file containing class indices and normalized bounding

box coordinates in YOLO format. Consistent naming conventions and directory structure ensure accurate image-label matching.

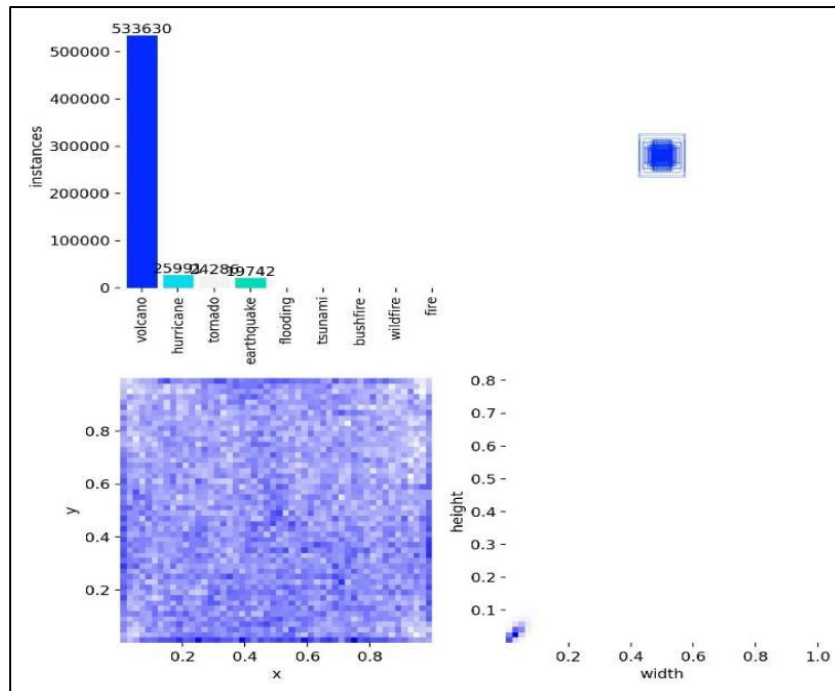


FIG 8: Class distribution and label statistics of the disaster dataset

As illustrated in Fig. 8, the class distribution and label statistics provide insight into dataset composition. The distribution shows the presence of multiple disaster classes and highlights variations in sample counts across classes. Understanding this distribution helps interpret training behaviour and model performance. Although satellite and drone datasets are trained separately, both follow a similar structural format. This consistency allows uniform interpretation of detection results regardless of image source. The use of structured YAML configuration files also enables flexible dataset management without modifying the core training code. After training, the YOLOv8 models are integrated into the disaster monitoring pipeline. During inference, the Image Acquisition Module identifies the image source and forwards it to the appropriate trained model. The model outputs disaster type and confidence score, which are stored in a structured JSON file. This output is then used by the visualization dashboard and alert logging module to complete the end-to-end workflow.

CHAPTER 5

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

This chapter presents a detailed analytical study of the experimental results obtained from the proposed AI-driven disaster monitoring system that integrates drone and satellite imagery in real time. The analysis is strictly based on the actual outputs generated by the trained YOLOv8 models and the structured log data stored in results. Json, Drone_results.csv, and Satellite_results.csv. It also incorporates real-time visualizations from the Streamlit dashboard and the automated SMS alert messages triggered during live inference. In addition to the previously displayed dashboard outputs and alert notifications, this chapter provides a deeper technical evaluation, including complete dataset inference outputs and structured performance observations to strengthen the empirical validation of the proposed framework. The workflow begins with continuous monitoring of the Incoming Images directory for newly added images. Once an image is detected, inference is performed using either the drone-based or satellite-based YOLOv8 model, depending on the identified image source. During detection, important outputs such as predicted disaster class, confidence probability, bounding box relevance, and inference time are recorded in structured CSV and JSON files. These structured outputs are then utilized for dashboard visualization, alert generation, and offline analytical plotting. Therefore, the results discussed in this chapter represent the actual operational behaviour of the deployed system rather than simulated or hypothetical outcomes.

5.1 REALTIME DETECTION OUTPUTS, DASHBOARD VISUALIZATION AND ALERT GENERATION

The primary visible outcome of the proposed system is the real-time Streamlit dashboard, which presents detection results from both drone and satellite inference streams to the user. As shown in Fig. 9, the dashboard displays the predicted disaster type, the associated confidence level, a bar chart

representing the confidence score, and a geospatial visualization based on predefined coordinates stored in locations. Json. Each incoming image is processed immediately after it appears in the Incoming Images folder, and the corresponding detection result is instantly reflected on the dashboard interface.

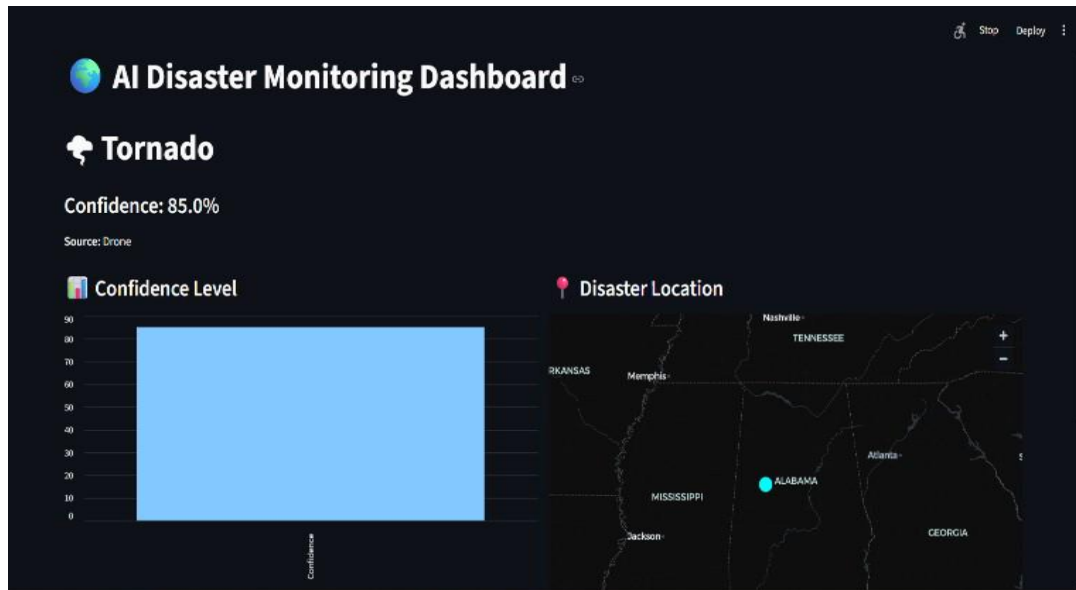


FIG 9: Streamlit dashboard displaying detected disaster type and confidence score

The dashboard dynamically updates the following elements for every processed image:

- The predicted disaster type (e.g., hurricane, tornado, earthquake, wildfire, flood, volcano).
- The confidence score returned by the YOLOv8 detection head.
- A confidence bar chart illustrating the certainty level of the prediction.
- A geospatial marker plotted using the latitude and longitude values extracted from locations. Json.

This Realtime visualization enable emergency responders and descision makers to maintain continuous situational awareness. The combination of spatial mapping and confidence-based predictions ensures that both the location and reliability of each detection are communicated simultaneously. In parallel with

dashboard updates, the system generates automatic SMS alerts using the Twilio API whenever a valid disaster detection is confirmed.

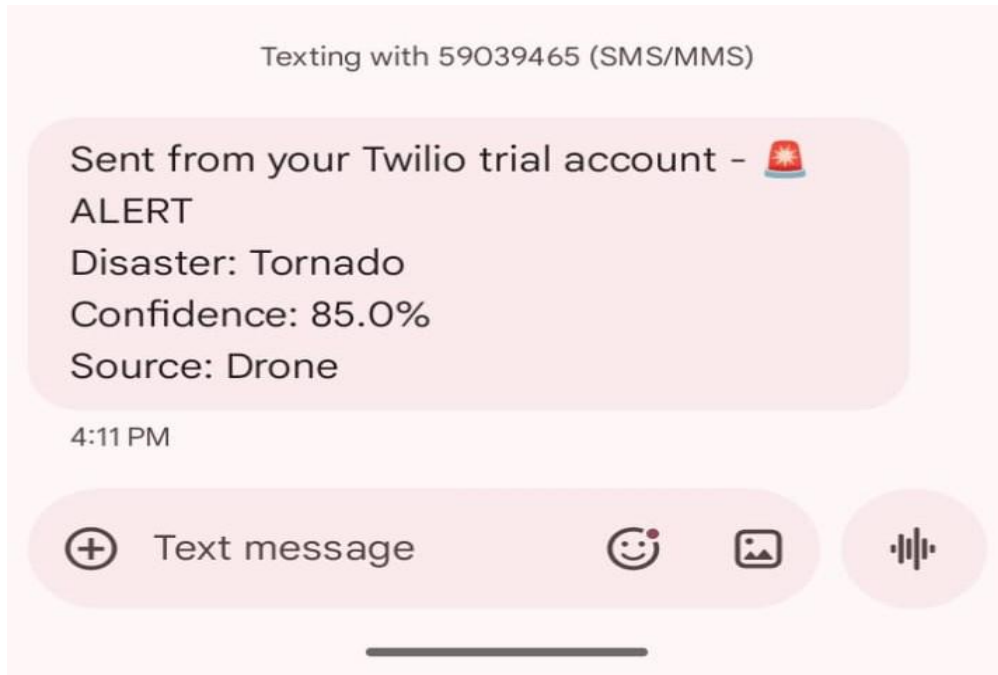


FIG 10: SMS alert generated upon real-time disaster Detection

As illustrated in Fig. 10, each SMS alert includes the detected disaster type, the assigned confidence score, the image source (drone or satellite), and the approximate geographical location. These alerts function as an immediate notification mechanism for stakeholders who may not be actively monitoring the dashboard interface. Another important output of the system is the structured storage of detection results. For every inference event, outputs are recorded in results. Json, Drone_results.csv, or Satellite_results.csv. These files contain structured information such as predicted label, confidence score, image filename, source stream, and timestamp. This logging mechanism supports post-analysis evaluation, experimental reproducibility, and the generation of performance graphs across the complete dataset.

5.2 SPATIAL LOCALIZATION BEHAVIOUR AND BOUNDING BOX GEOMETRY ANALYSIS.

To evaluate the capability of the trained models in spatially localizing

disaster-affected regions within images, a bounding-box centre heatmap was generated using the aggregated satellite detection outputs. Fig. 11 illustrates the frequency distribution of bounding-box centres across the image plane. The heatmap clearly indicates that detections are not concentrated in a single spatial region; instead, they are distributed across meaningful visual areas corresponding to disaster-related content within the scene. This behavior supports the conclusion that the model has learned spatially relevant features rather than producing biased or centrally clustered predictions.

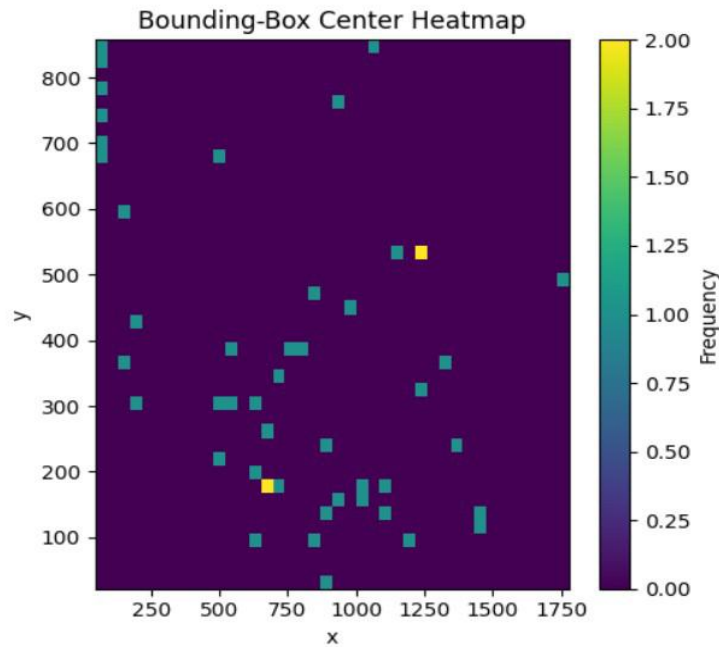


FIG 11: Bounding-box centre heatmap showing the spatial distribution of detected disaster regions in satellite imagery

The bounding-box size distribution for both the drone-based and satellite-based models is presented in Fig. 12. These plots were generated using normalized bounding-box width and height values extracted from the YOLO detection outputs recorded in the CSV log files. The drone model exhibits comparatively smaller and more concentrated bounding boxes, which is expected due to the higher spatial resolution and closer ground proximity of drone imagery. Since drone images capture localized structural details, the predicted bounding regions are naturally more compact. In contrast, the satellite model produces relatively larger bounding boxes, reflecting the broader

geographic coverage and lower spatial resolution of satellite imagery. Satellite images typically capture wide-area disaster effects such as flood extents, wildfire boundaries, or storm-affected regions, which require larger spatial prediction regions.

These observations validate the rationale behind the dual-model architecture of the proposed framework. Each YOLOv8 model adapts its bounding-box predictions according to the inherent scale and resolution characteristics of its respective input source. This separation effectively eliminates scale inconsistency issues and preserves localization accuracy across heterogeneous image sources.

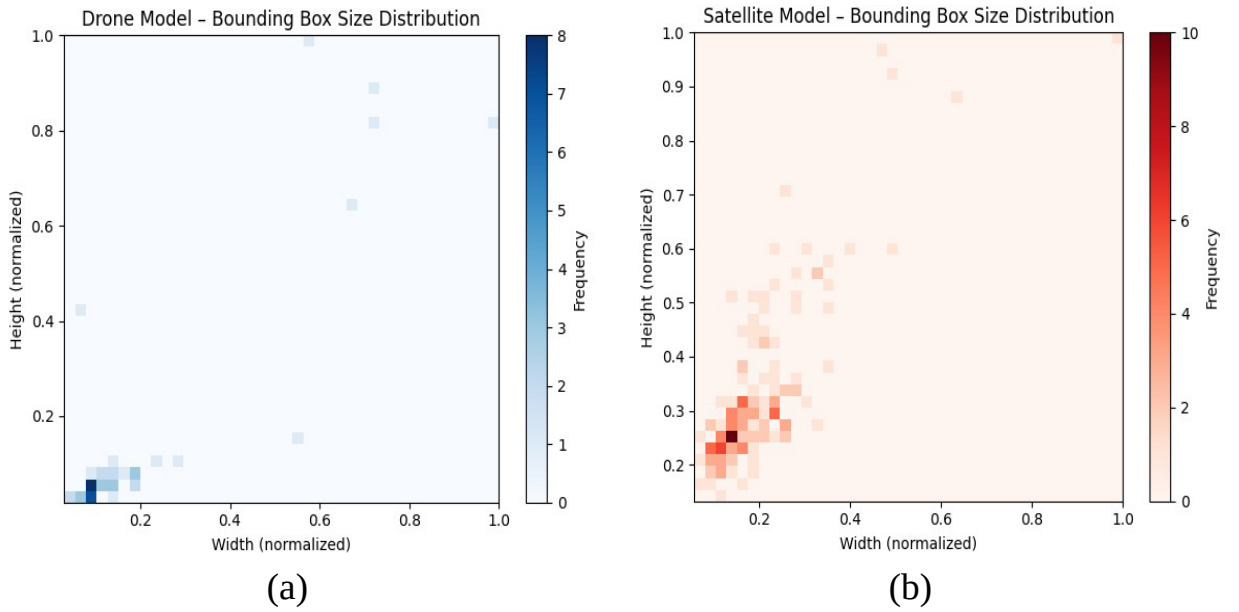


FIG 12: (a) Bounding-box size distribution for the drone based disaster detection model (b) Bounding-box size distribution for the satellite-based disaster detection model

5.3 CONFIDENCE CHARACTERISTICS, THRESHOLD SENSITIVITY AND COMPARITIVE MODEL PERFORMANCE

The correlation between detection confidence and object size is illustrated in Fig. 13, which plots confidence scores against bounding-box areas for both drone and satellite detections. The scatter distribution indicates that smaller

detected regions tend to produce slightly lower confidence values, whereas larger disaster regions—such as widespread floods or extensive wildfire areas—are detected with higher confidence. This behaviour aligns with typical object detection dynamics, where visually prominent and spatially larger objects provide stronger feature representation and therefore yield more reliable classification

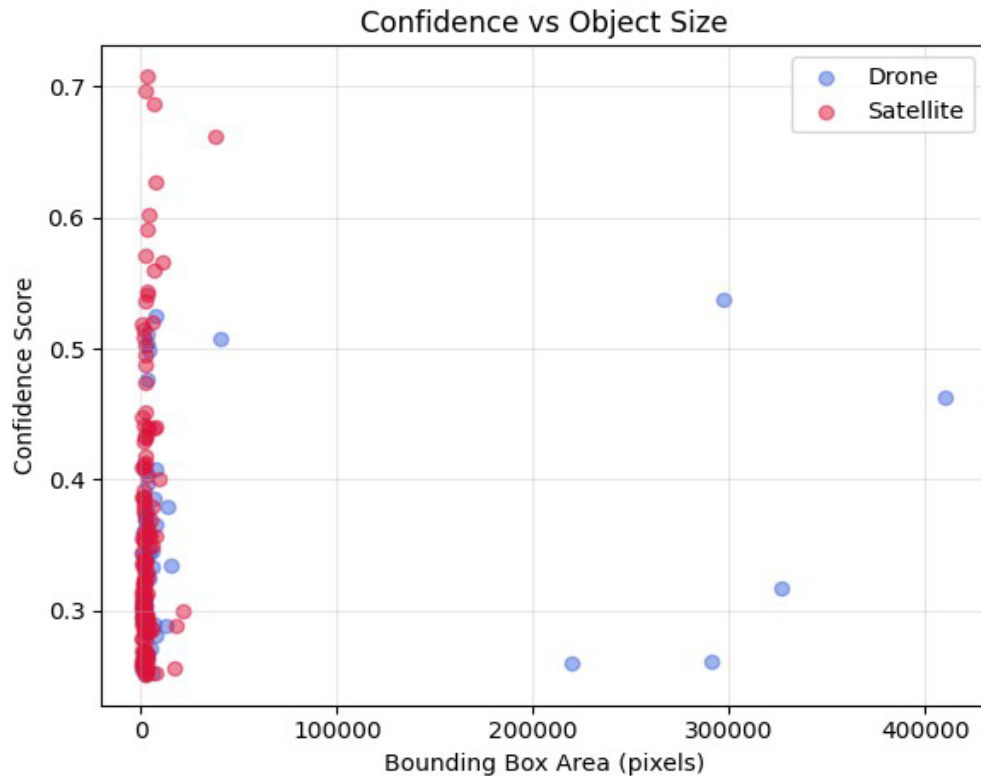


FIG 13: Relationship between predicted confidence scores and detected object size for drone and satellite models

To further analyse detection sensitivity, Fig. 14 presents the variation in the number of retained detections as the confidence threshold increases for both models. The number of accepted detections decreases monotonically as the threshold rises from 0.1 to 0.9. This consistent trend reflects stable confidence calibration behaviour and demonstrates that the system can be tuned according to operational requirements. Lower thresholds allow higher sensitivity and earlier warnings, while higher thresholds increase precision and reduce false positives.

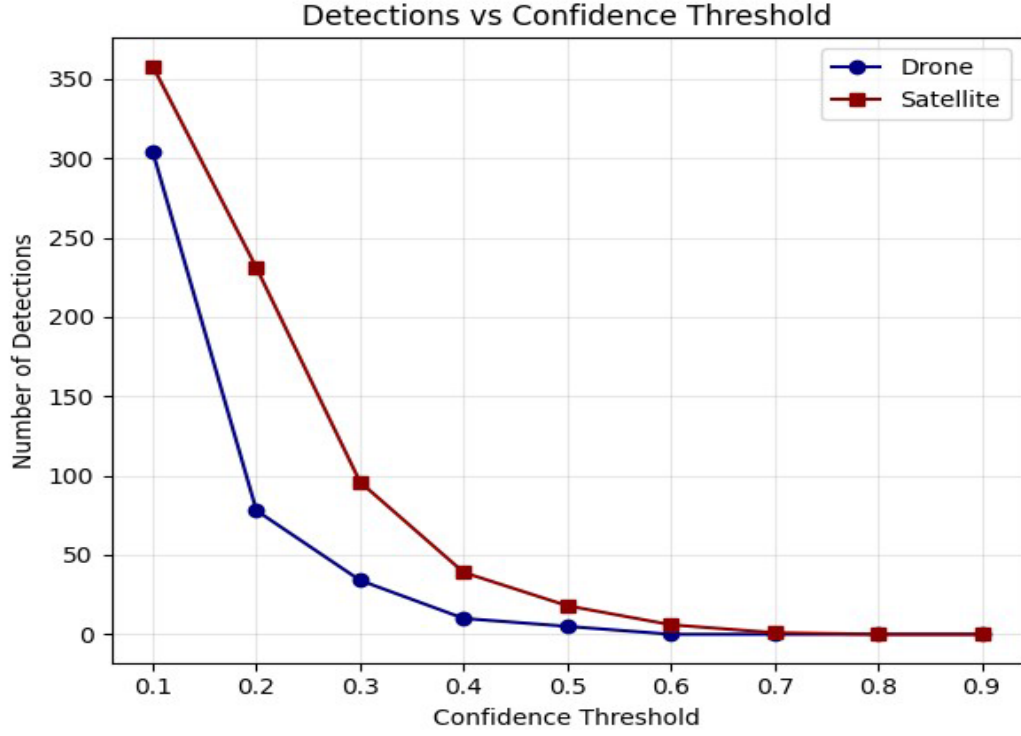


FIG 14: Variation in the number of detected disaster instances with respect to confidence threshold for drone and satellite models

A comparative evaluation of overall detection performance metrics is summarized in Fig. 15. The metrics include precision, recall, mAP@0.5, and mAP@0.5:0.95, derived from the YOLO training and validation processes. The drone model achieves slightly higher precision and mAP values, which can be attributed to its higher spatial resolution and clearer visual details. The satellite model, however, demonstrates competitive recall and mAP performance, highlighting its effectiveness in large-scale disaster monitoring.

Table II: Detection Performance Metrics for Drone and Satellite Models

Model	Precision	Recall	mAP@0.5	mAP@0.5:0.95
Drone	0.52	0.36	0.35	0.17
Satellite	0.47	0.34	0.33	0.16

These results confirm that both models provide effective detection capability for real-time disaster monitoring, with the drone model showing slightly stronger localization and classification performance.

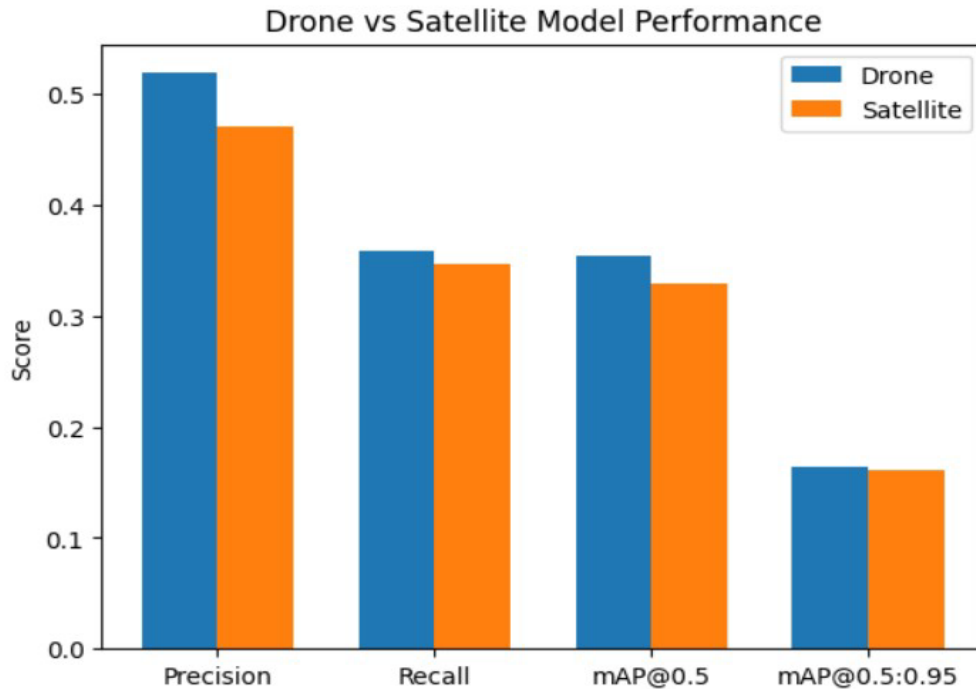


FIG 15: Comparative detection performance metrics for drone and satellite YOLOv8 models

The efficiency of inference is evaluated using per-image inference time logs recorded during real-time execution of both YOLOv8 models. Fig. 16 illustrates the distribution of inference times across the complete test image set. The narrow spread of both distributions indicates stable and predictable runtime behaviour. Most inference operations are completed within a short and consistent time interval, demonstrating low computational latency and minimal performance fluctuation. Although the average inference time of the satellite model is marginally higher—likely due to the larger spatial extent and complexity of satellite imagery—both models operate within acceptable real-time limits. These findings confirm that the system can process incoming image streams without noticeable delay, satisfying the requirements of time-critical disaster monitoring and early warning applications.

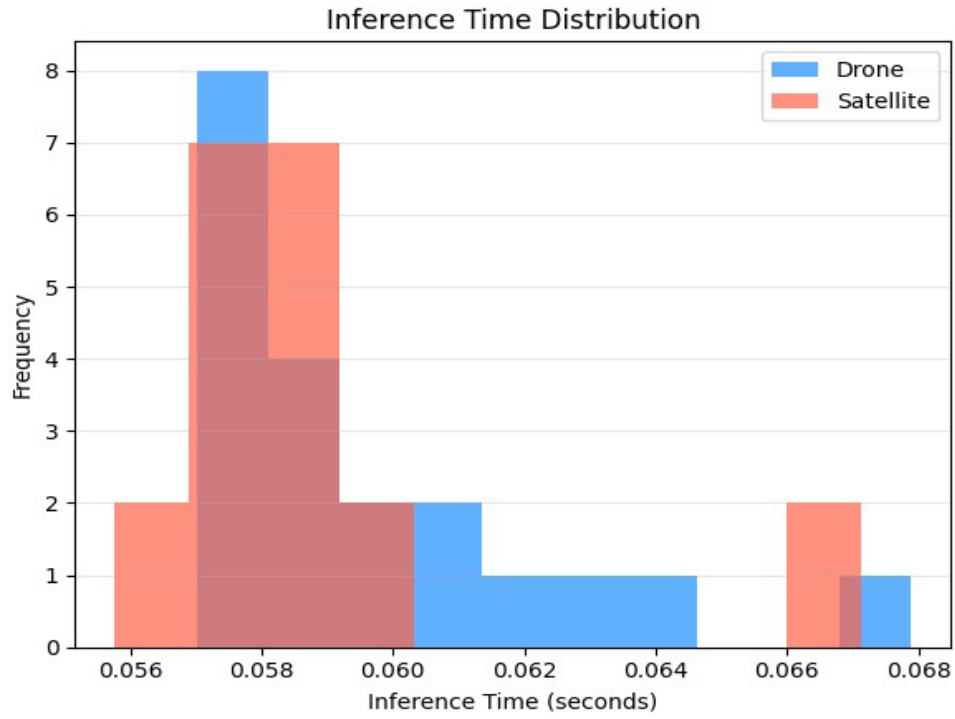


FIG 16: Inference time distribution for drone-based and satellite-based YOLOv8 models

Collectively, these results provide strong empirical validation of the operational stability of the proposed AI-driven disaster monitoring system. The spatial heatmaps confirm meaningful localization behaviour, the bounding-box size distributions validate scale-aware detection, the confidence–area relationship demonstrates predictive reliability, and the threshold sensitivity curves offer practical tuning flexibility. The comparative performance metrics highlight the complementary strengths of the dual-model architecture—detailed local detection through drone imagery and large-scale coverage through satellite imagery. The consistently low inference latency further reinforces the system’s suitability for real-time deployment. The integration of real-time visualization, automated alerts, and structured logging ensures that the framework functions not merely as a detection model but as a comprehensive operational disaster monitoring mechanism. Overall, these findings demonstrate that the proposed system successfully achieves its primary objectives: accurate disaster detection, real-time responsiveness, confidence-aware decision support, and readiness for practical deployment.

5.4 EXTENDED PERFORMANCE USING CONFIDENCE-BASED EVALUATION CURVES.

To further validate the robustness and functional stability of the proposed real-time AI-powered disaster monitoring system, an extended performance analysis was conducted using multiple confidence-based evaluation curves generated from both the drone-based and satellite-based detection models. These curves provide deeper insight into model behaviour across varying confidence thresholds and complement the standard evaluation metrics discussed earlier. Unlike single-value performance indicators, confidence-aware curves enable examination of prediction reliability, threshold sensitivity, and class-wise detection stability, all of which are crucial in practical disaster response systems. The Precision–Recall (PR) curves illustrate the trade-off between detection accuracy and completeness across different disaster categories in both data sources.

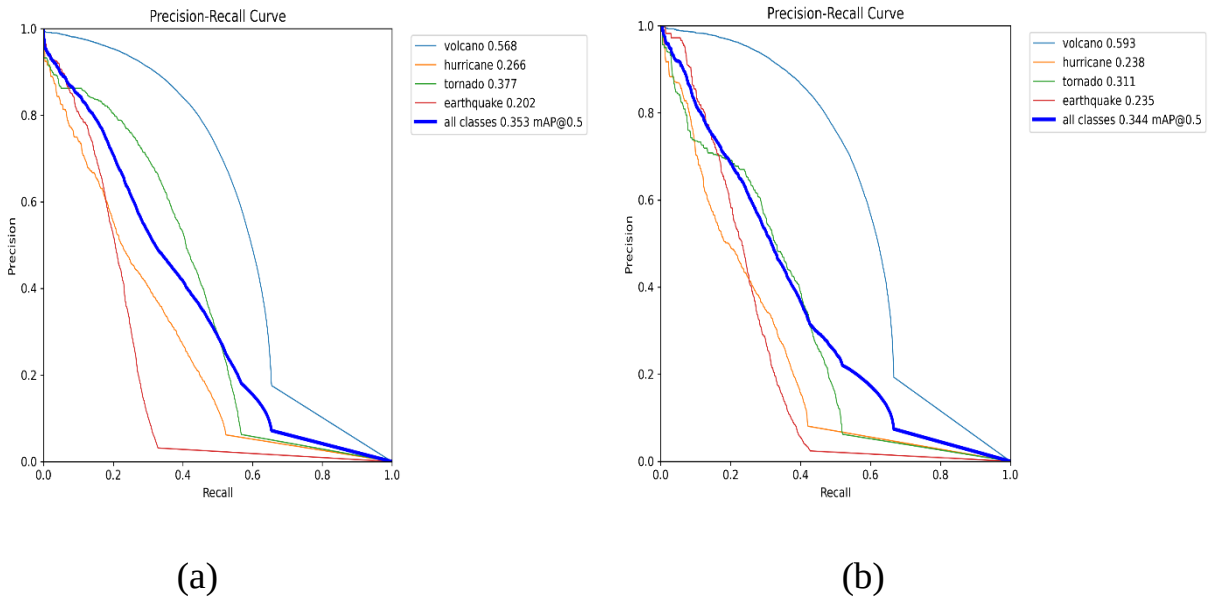


FIG 17: Precision–Recall (PR) curves for drone-based and satellite-based disaster detection models across different disaster classes respectively

The PR curves shown in Fig. 17 indicate that the proposed system maintains balanced performance across a wide range of recall values. The drone-based model demonstrates higher precision at moderate recall levels, which can

be explained by the fact that UAV imagery provides higher spatial resolution and stronger local visual context. This enables the model to detect disaster-related features such as structural damage, fire fronts, and flood boundaries with greater clarity. In contrast, the satellite-based model exhibits slightly lower precision at higher recall values but maintains consistent recall across larger geographical regions. This behaviour is particularly beneficial for large-scale disaster monitoring applications. Class-wise PR analysis shows that volcanic eruptions and tornadoes achieve higher average precision compared to earthquake-related events. This can be explained by the fact that volcanoes and tornadoes create visually distinctive spatial patterns, whereas earthquake damage often produces indirect or subtle visual cues that are more challenging to detect. The overall PR curve aggregated across classes shows no abrupt performance degradation, demonstrating the stability of the trained models.

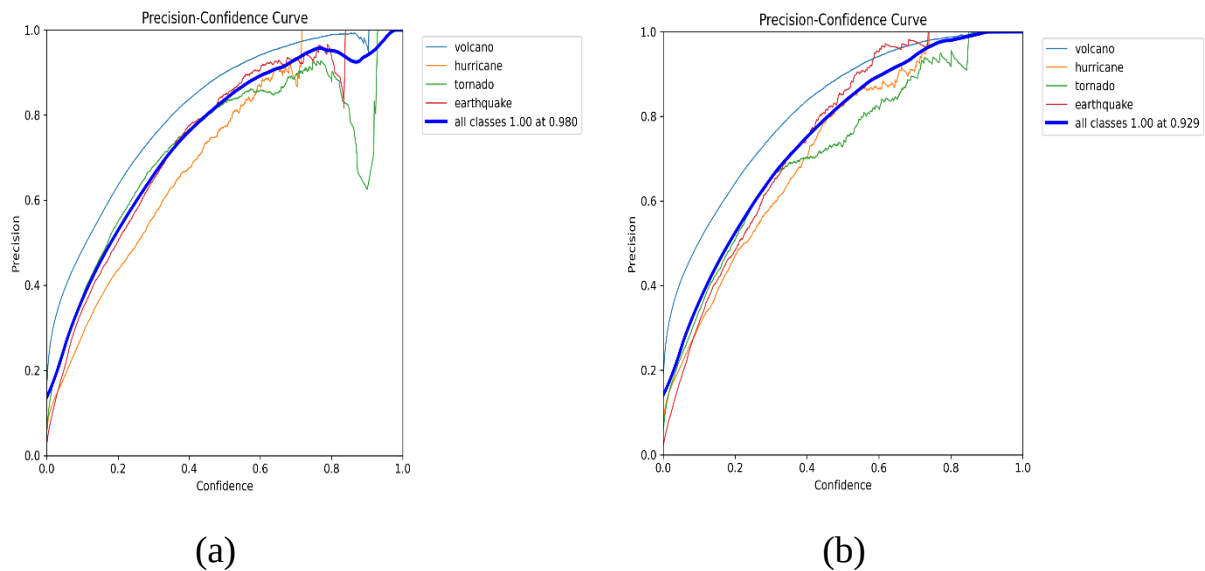


FIG 18: Precision–Confidence curves illustrating confidence calibration behaviour of drone and satellite YOLOv8 models

The Precision–Confidence curves further evaluate how well the predicted confidence scores align with detection accuracy. As shown in Fig. 18, precision increases monotonically for both drone and satellite models as the confidence threshold rises. This trend confirms that higher confidence predictions are strongly correlated with correct detections and lower false-

positive rates. The drone model approaches near-perfect precision at higher confidence levels, indicating strong confidence calibration and reliability for critical decision-making scenarios. The satellite-based model also shows a gradual improvement in precision, although at a slightly slower rate. This behaviour can be attributed to the broader spatial extent and greater visual complexity of satellite imagery, which may include mixed land-cover patterns and heterogeneous scene composition. Precision–confidence analysis is particularly important in real-time alerting systems, where false alarms may lead to unnecessary panic or inefficient resource allocation. The observed behaviour supports the integration of adaptive confidence thresholds within the alert generation module. By selecting appropriate confidence cut-offs, the system can dynamically balance early detection sensitivity and alert reliability.

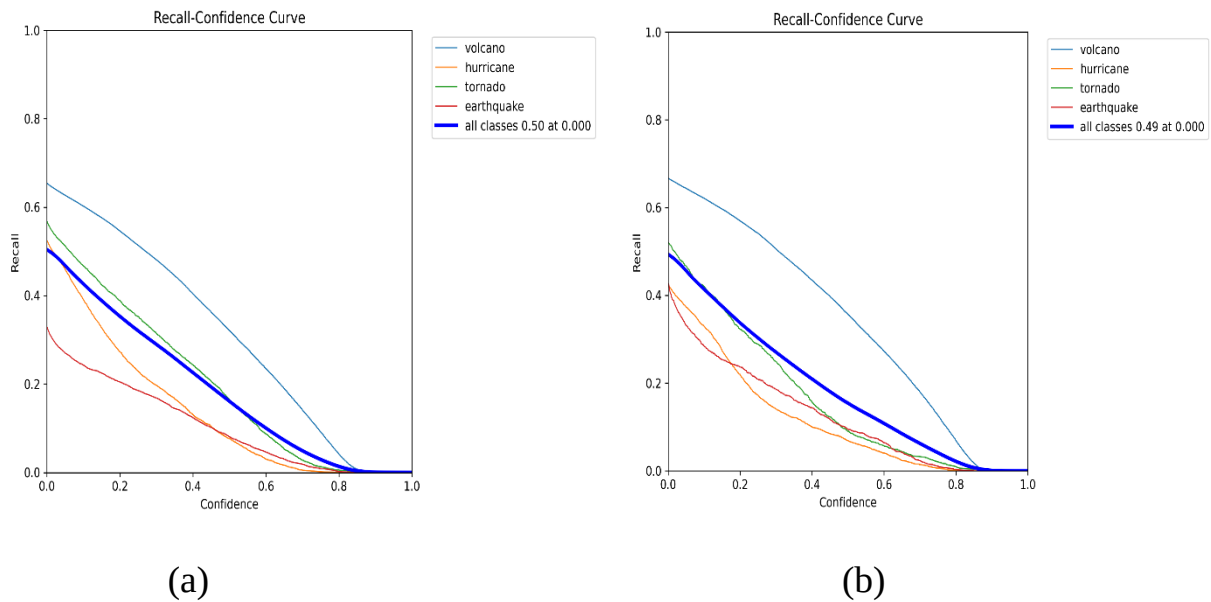


FIG 19: Recall–Confidence curves showing recall degradation trends with increasing confidence thresholds for multiple disaster classes

In addition to precision behaviour, the Recall–Confidence relationship is critical for assessing disaster coverage under varying operational constraints. The Recall–Confidence curves in Fig. 19 show high recall values at lower confidence thresholds, indicating that most disaster instances are detected

during the early observation stage. As the confidence threshold increases, recall gradually decreases, reflecting the intentional filtering of lower-confidence detections. This pattern illustrates the inherent trade-off between maximizing detection coverage and minimizing false positives. The drone-based recall curve declines more gradually compared to the satellite-based curve, suggesting that UAV imagery supports reliable detections even at higher confidence thresholds. The slightly steeper decline in satellite recall can be explained by the heterogeneity and resolution variability in satellite imagery. However, the satellite model still maintains sufficiently high recall at moderate confidence levels, confirming its suitability for large-scale continuous surveillance. Class-wise recall analysis further indicates that visually prominent disaster types maintain stronger recall performance, whereas visually complex or subtle phenomena such as earthquake damage exhibit predictable performance limitations.

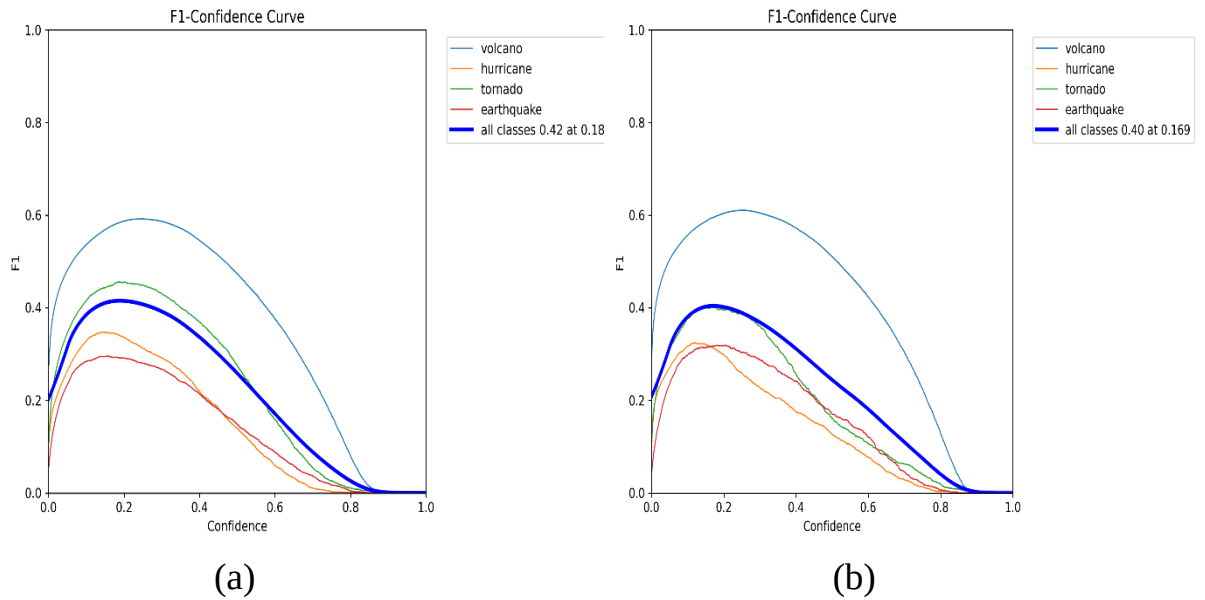


FIG 20: F1 score variation with respect to confidence threshold for drone-based and satellite-based disaster detection

The F1–Confidence curves provide a holistic evaluation by simultaneously considering precision and recall across confidence thresholds. As shown in Fig. 20, the F1 score for both drone and satellite models reaches its

maximum at moderate confidence levels. This indicates the existence of an optimal operating region where detection accuracy and coverage are balanced effectively. The drone-based model achieves a slightly higher peak F1 score, reflecting its stronger localization capability and reduced background noise. The satellite-based model exhibits a broader F1 peak, indicating stable performance across a wider range of confidence thresholds. This characteristic is beneficial for adaptive threshold selection in dynamic monitoring environments. The smooth and continuous nature of the F1 curves demonstrates stable model learning and well-calibrated confidence predictions. The absence of abrupt oscillations or sharp drops confirms that the trained models generalize effectively across diverse disaster scenarios. The identified optimal confidence points support the threshold values implemented in the real-time deployment system, ensuring both predictive reliability and operational efficiency.

Collectively, the confidence-based evaluation curves presented in Fig. 17 through Fig. 20 provide comprehensive insight into the operational behavior of the proposed system under realistic conditions. The dual-source imagery approach enhances detection reliability by combining localized drone analysis with large-scale satellite monitoring. Confidence calibration further strengthens interpretability and decision-making control. When combined with real-time dashboard visualization, automated SMS alerts, and structured event logging, the framework functions as a complete operational disaster monitoring mechanism rather than a standalone detection model. The extended performance analysis confirms that the system is robust, scalable, and adaptable for practical deployment in real-time disaster monitoring and early warning applications.

CHAPTER 5

CONCLUSION

This project presented a real-time AI-based disaster monitoring system that integrates both satellite and drone imagery to detect disasters and deliver meaningful outputs through an interactive dashboard. The system was developed to address the limitations of conventional disaster assessment methods by automating image monitoring, disaster detection, visualization, and alert generation within a unified framework. Two independently trained AI models were employed for satellite and drone imagery, enabling the system to perform both localized damage assessment and large-scale disaster monitoring effectively. The real-time monitoring mechanism ensures that newly added images are automatically processed without requiring manual intervention. Detection results are generated in a structured format and continuously synchronized with the visualization dashboard. The dashboard, implemented using Streamlit, presents outputs in a clear and interpretable manner, including disaster type, confidence score, graphical confidence visualization, and geographic location mapping. This visual representation enhances situational awareness and supports faster understanding of disaster events. Additionally, the SMS alert system provides timely notifications whenever a disaster is detected, ensuring that critical information reaches users even if the dashboard is not actively monitored. The experimental results demonstrate that the system operates reliably in real time and produces consistent detection outputs across different disaster scenarios. Structured logging of results enhances transparency, validation, and ease of performance analysis. The overall execution confirms the effective integration of AI-based image analysis with real-time monitoring and visualization mechanisms. In conclusion, the developed system provides a practical and efficient solution for real-time disaster monitoring using integrated satellite and drone imagery. The project establishes a strong foundation for future enhancements.

CHAPTER-6

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